

AMERICAS UTILITIES: POWER

PUCT approves Oncor's 765-kV select transmission lines; reliability being prioritized to meet growing TX demand

On August 28, 2026, the Public Utility Commission of Texas (PUCT) voted approving Oncor's Certificate of Convenience and Necessity (CCN) application for 765-kV transmission projects that were being debated amongst regulators. The decision overturns the ALJ's recommendation to deny the project over notice deficiencies and reflects the Commission's focus on reliability while meeting growing power demand. Investors were also focused on the ruling and its potential implications to the Batch Zero process at ERCOT, which has been facing uncertainty given the governors directive on conducting audits prior to data centers getting connected to the grid. Ahead of the ruling, utilities and specialty contractors saw a constructive case for the projects to move forward given the grid reliability implications that have been publicly talked about at the Commissioner/ERCOT level. We view this as a positive for Texas utilities given the support for capital investment into Texas load growth, and we reiterate our Buy Rating on **SRE**, where we see ~30% upside to our \$110 price target.

Events leading up to the open meeting: On August 3, Texas Governor Abbott ordered the PUCT and ERCOT to conduct an a comprehensive audit on energy, water, and financial commitments for all data centers advancing through ERCOT's interconnection process. Shortly after, on August 20, state administrative law judges recommended that the PUCT deny Oncor's primary 765-kV line application, ruling that Oncor failed to prove the massive lines were necessary and failed to properly notify over impacted landowners. This decision triggered political friction with various state lawmakers urging the PUCT to deny or freeze all 765-kV applications until the Legislature can reform grid expansion laws in 2027. While Oncor pushed back noting that it followed notice requirements and that the high-voltage lines are vital to support West Texas energy growth, the dispute culminated in today's PUCT open meeting, where regulators decided whether to approve Oncor's filings, reject the line, or pause the process for legislative reform.

The Ruling: The PUCT voted to approve Oncor's Certificate of Convenience and Necessity (CCN) application for the Longshore Switch-Drill Hole Switch and Dinosaur Switch – Longshore Switch 765-kV transmission lines, overturning the ALJ's recommendation to deny the project over notice deficiencies. The PUCT ruled that Oncor satisfied all statutory requirements, clarifying that state regulations only mandate a single public meeting prior to filing rather than separate meetings for

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every subsequent route modification. However, in response to public opposition, the Commission incorporated binding language ordering Oncor to work directly with affected property owners to adjust alignments and avoid bisecting private and generational ranch lands wherever possible. The PUCT established strict regulatory oversight, warning Oncor that its good-faith engagement with landowners will be audited and factored into future utility rate proceedings.

Next steps: From here, we look to see if anything will be publicly shared on the August 31 deadline for developers seeking to participate in Batch Zero to resolve any technical issues in their applications. We also look to December 10 which is the target date set by ERCOT to complete and file its audit on the Batch Zero queue with the PUCT.

Our View/Stock Implications: The ruling today is reflective of the state's commitment to urgency around addressing broader reliability concerns as power demand grows in west Texas. We also believe having clarity on these lines provides a mitigant to concerns around further delays in the Batch Zero process. The ruling is supportive of our Buy Rating on SRE where we believe Oncor's \$47.5 bn base capital plan and \$10 bn of incremental capex supports ~10% annual EPS growth through 2030 in our forecasts.

Valuation and risks

SRE. We are Buy rated on Sempra with a 12-month SOTP based PT of \$110. Key downside risks for SRE include (1) management execution and communication challenges, (2) balance sheet strength weakens, and (3) constructive regulatory outcomes.

Disclosure Appendix

Reg AC

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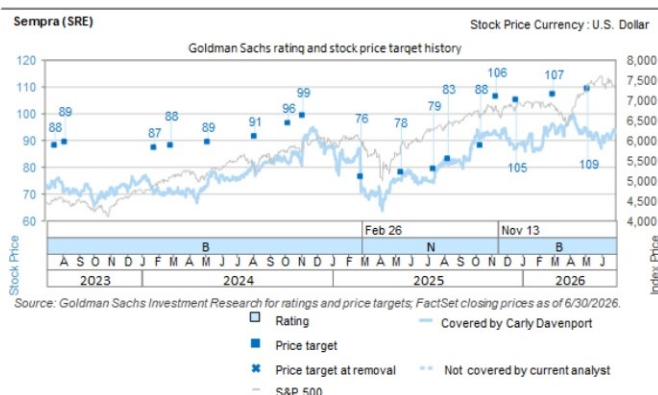
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Semptra (SRE)

Date of report	Target price (\$)	Closing price (\$)
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08-May-26	109.00	91.53
02-Mar-26	107.00	95.67
21-Dec-25	105.00	86.94
13-Nov-25	106.00	92.22
14-Oct-25	88.00	91.33
12-Aug-25	83.00	82.09
15-Jul-25	79.00	74.14
13-May-25	78.00	75.13
26-Feb-25	76.00	72.85
07-Nov-24	99.00	89.76
09-Oct-24	96.00	81.52
07-Aug-24	91.00	77.26
08-May-24	89.00	75.23
28-Feb-24	88.00	70.67
25-Jan-24	87.00	70.73

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